

A MESSAGE FROM THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Dear Shareholders:

We, the members of the HON INDUSTRIES Board of Directors, believe that integrity is central to good corporate governance. This belief is reflected in the HON INDUSTRIES vision statement (shown on the back of this annual report), adopted many years ago. Our Vision statement represents much more than a traditional “mission,” and it goes much deeper than company policy. The beliefs and values represented in that document are the very foundation of our corporate culture, and guide the attitude and actions of every member, every day.

From its beginnings, HON INDUSTRIES has sought to implement its vision through sound policies and practices, and by maintaining a strong Board composed predominantly of outside directors. We are fully committed to executing our responsibilities, and we will continue to maintain the company’s long-standing tradition of an independent, well-informed, active, and engaged Board of Directors.

Our board meetings and procedures have been developed and refined to encourage open and informed communication. The company’s accounting policies have always been conservative and straightforward. The Board’s three committees — Audit; Human Resources and Compensation; Public Policy and Corporate Governance — have consisted entirely of non-management directors for many years.

During 2003, we have given significant attention to the newly released rules emanating from the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002 and the New York Stock Exchange listing requirements — rules intended to improve corporate governance across the country. It is gratifying to report that HON INDUSTRIES governance practices were already in accord with the spirit of the rules.

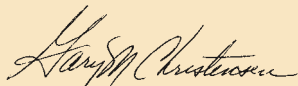
It is an honor to serve as directors of HON INDUSTRIES. We are very proud to represent you, the shareholder, as we oversee the management of this great company. Please be assured that we intend to remain vigilant and focused on good corporate governance.

Sincerely,

The HON INDUSTRIES Board of Directors



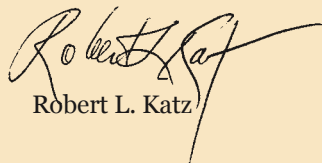
Stan A. Askren



Gary M. Christensen



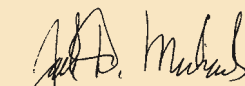
Cheryl A. Francis



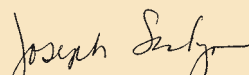
Robert L. Katz



Dennis J. Martin



Jack D. Michaels



Joseph Scalzo



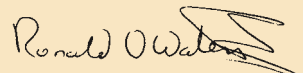
Abbie J. Smith



Richard H. Stanley



Brian E. Stern



Ronald V. Waters, III